THE LANGUAGE OF SCENT

Making fragrance easier to understand.

A visual exploration of scent categories, notes,
and the relationships behind fragrance descriptions.

DESIGN PROPOSAL / WEEK 06

Why is fragrance hard to describe?

Perfume descriptions mix scent families, recognizable notes and subjective impressions.

FAMILY

Floral

Overall direction

NOTE

Rose

Recognizable scent impression

DESCRIPTOR

Powdery

How a scent may feel

The issue is not a lack of perfume information, but how overlapping terms and combinations are explained.

How the concept evolved.

An initial discovery-and-recommendation idea shifted toward understanding fragrance information first.

01

INITIAL IDEA

Visualize scents, identify preferences and find similar perfumes.

02

EXISTING SERVICES

Search and recommendation tools already address much of that need.

03

DISCOVERED GAP

Terms overlap; mixtures and sensory descriptions are difficult to interpret.

04

DESIGN DIRECTION

Organize fragrance concepts and make their relationships visible.

INTENDED EXPERIENCE

I want users to get a clearer sense of what fragrance descriptions actually mean through colors, images, and textures, rather than relying on words alone.

By exploring different fragrance families and their related notes, users can see how scents are classified, how they overlap, and how different impressions connect. Instead of presenting everything at once, the website allows users to explore these relationships gradually through interaction.

Choosing a useful family framework.

The Perfume Society's eight-family system is a starting point; other professional frameworks divide fragrance differently.

- Fresh
- Floral
- Floriental
- Ambrée
- Gourmand
- Chypre
- Woody
- Fougère

Source framework: The Perfume Society / Other professional classifications also exist.

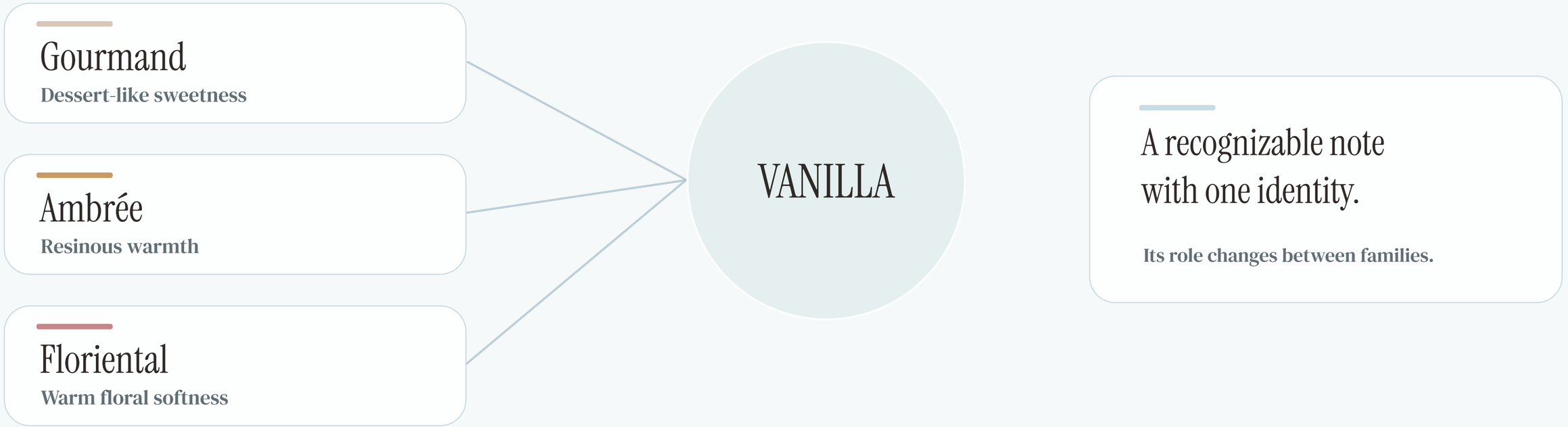
Decisions behind the classification.

Different vocabularies, overlapping terms, and too much information at once shaped the structure.

01	SEPARATE THE CONCEPTS	Distinct types: Family / Note / Descriptor
02	SELECT A TEACHABLE SCOPE	Eight families with representative scent concepts
03	STORE SHARED TERMS ONCE	Vanilla links to several families without duplication
04	REVEAL INFORMATION GRADUALLY	Begin with families; reveal linked notes and descriptors
05	REMOVE UNRELATED COMPLEXITY	Keep accords/materials contextual; omit time evolution

One concept. Multiple connections.

Internal data records are shared; the interface changes the explanation to match the context.



Links explain scent associations. They are not measured similarity scores.

A curated dataset, not a universal catalog.

A curated working model used to design relationships, not a scientific or industry-wide inventory.

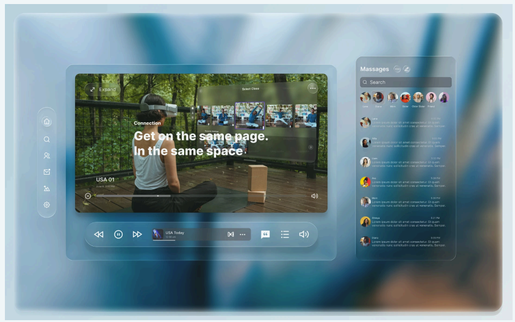
08	33	24	48	40
FAMILIES	UNIQUE NOTES	DESCRIPTORS	FAMILY–NOTE LINKS	FAMILY–DESCRIPTOR LINKS

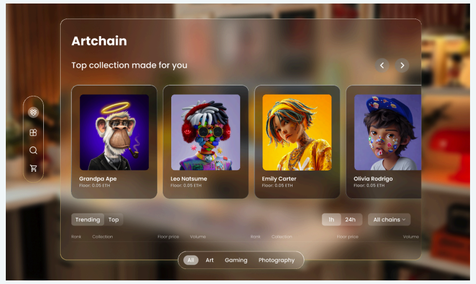
A Note does not inherit every Descriptor from its Family. Individual links require contextual review.

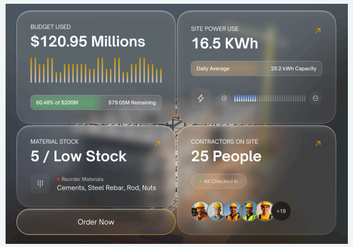
References & moodboard.

Visual and interaction references alongside the atmosphere I want the website to communicate.

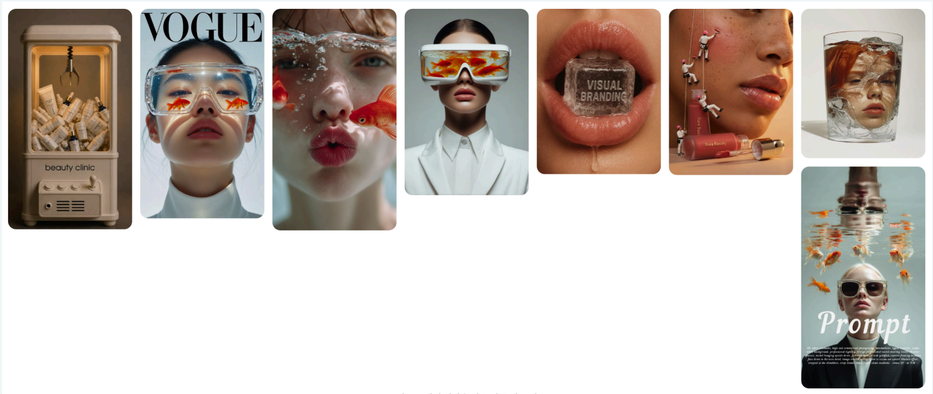
DESIGN & EXPERIENCE REFERENCES







MOOD / VISION BOARD



Transparent Nude White + Experimental Beauty Editorial.

Neutral white and nude tones give scent families room to stand out; a clean laboratory-inspired structure makes their relationships easier to follow.

SOFT WHITE
#F7F6F3

GLASS GRAY
#DDE2E5

WATER BLUE
#C8DDE2

MUTED ROSE
#C98688

CHARCOAL
#302B28

A refined, sensory interface.

Instrument Serif + DM Sans / Liquid Glass-inspired layers were added to express transparency and depth, not as the original concept.

How the website is organized.

A content map showing the main sections and nested exploration states, independent of the final page navigation.



A journey through connected scents.

Example flow: choose Floral, investigate Iris and its powdery impression, then compare and return.

01 / START

LEARN

Understand Family, Note and Descriptor.

→

02 / EXPLORE

FLORAL

Select one of eight families.

→

03 / FOLLOW A NOTE

IRIS

See its scent identity and related descriptors.

→

04 / INVESTIGATE

POWDERY

Explore how the sensory impression is described.

→

05 / COMPARE

POWDERY / SOAPY

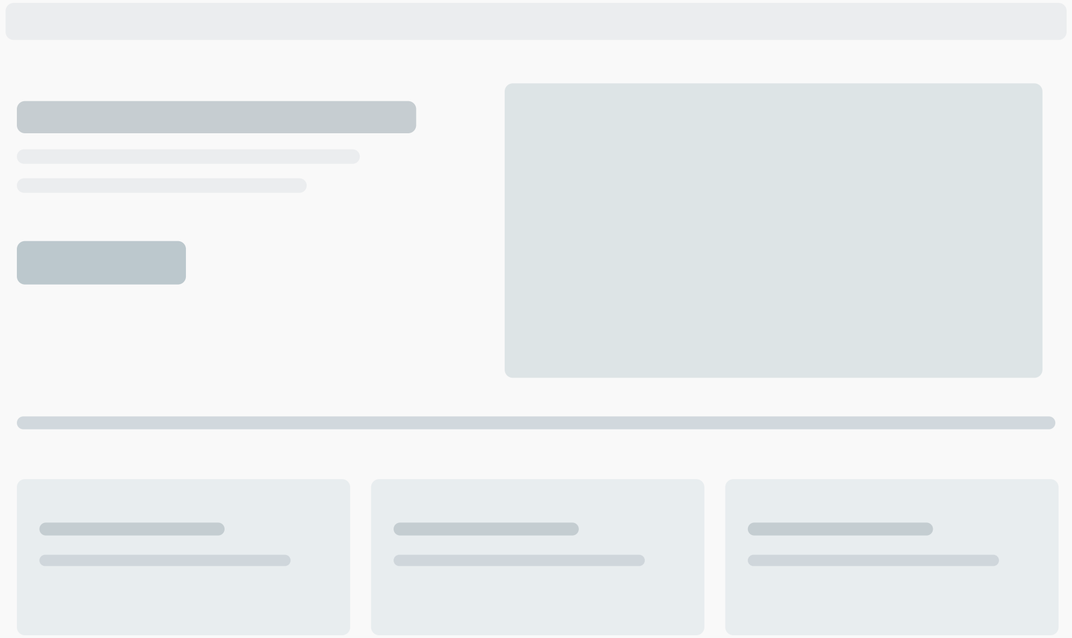
Understand the difference; return to Atlas.

AFTER COMPARISON ↶ Return to the selected concept or Atlas to continue exploring.

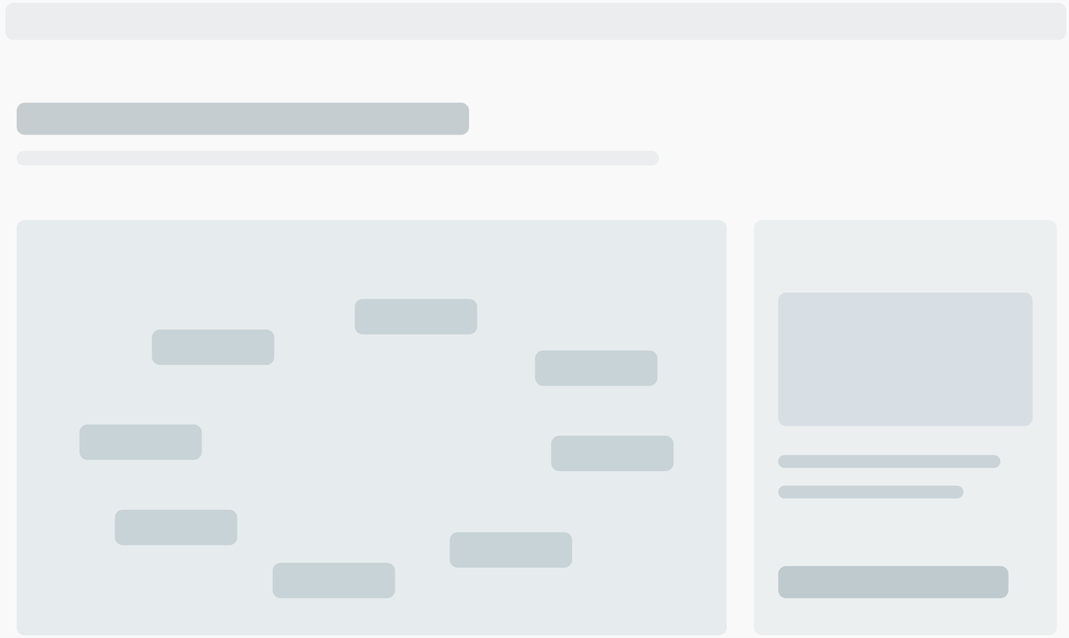
Wireframes - layout and hierarchy.

Simplified structure of the homepage and Atlas before visual styling.

01 / HOMEPAGE + LEARN

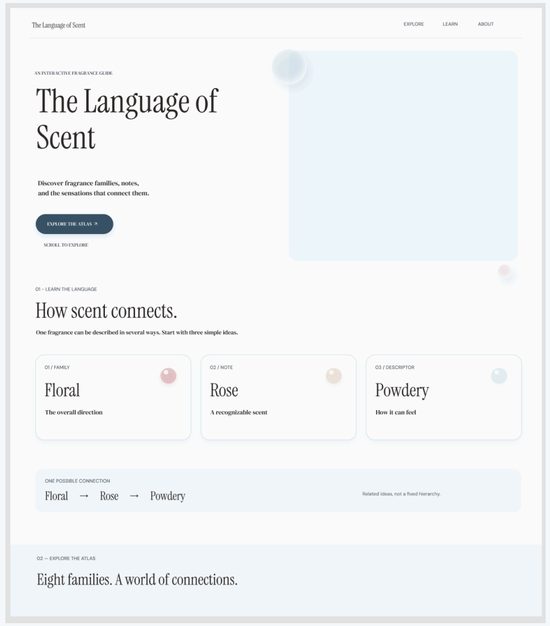


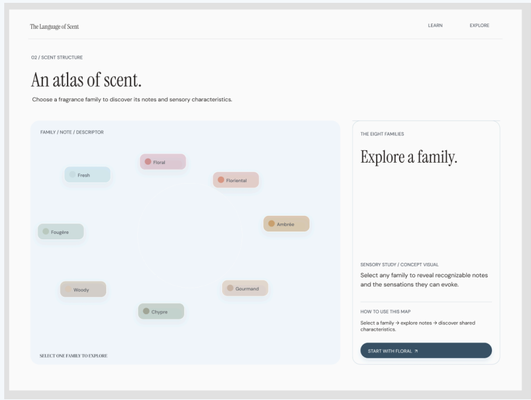
02 / ATLAS OVERVIEW

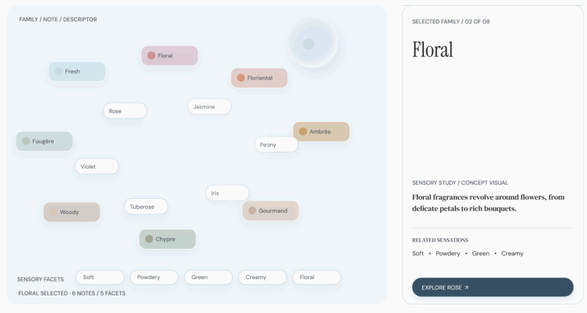


Design preview

Place the final homepage, Atlas expansion, or other representative Figma screens here.







Compare descriptions that feel similar.

A contextual comparison helps users understand subtle differences between easily confused scent impressions.

01 / THE PROBLEM

Words alone can be hard to picture.

Terms such as Soapy and Powdery describe sensory impressions, but their differences may be unclear without context.

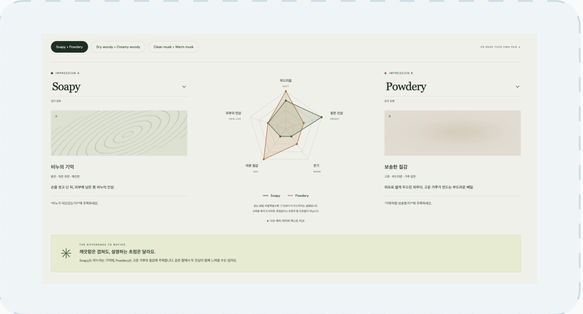
02 / THE INTERACTION

Explore → Select → Compare

From a selected note or descriptor, users can open a side-by-side comparison with short explanations and sensory imagery.

Selected scent → Compare → Understand

03 / VISUAL STUDY



A five-axis radar chart was an early idea. The visual format is still being evaluated to avoid implying measured scent values.

EXAMPLE PAIR: SOAPY × POWDERY • COMPARISON VISUALIZATION IS STILL IN DEVELOPMENT

Responsive & Interaction

Mobile reorganizes the map and details into a sequential, touch-friendly exploration.

DESKTOP

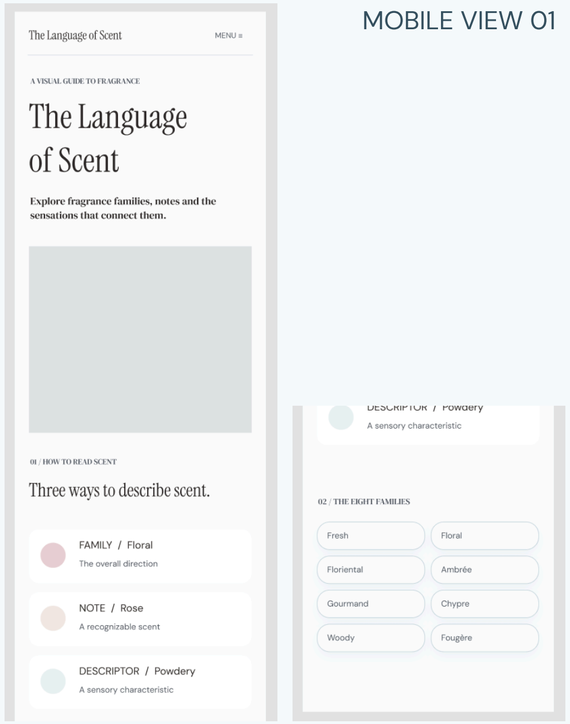
Map + detail panel

Spatial relationships and explanations can be viewed together.

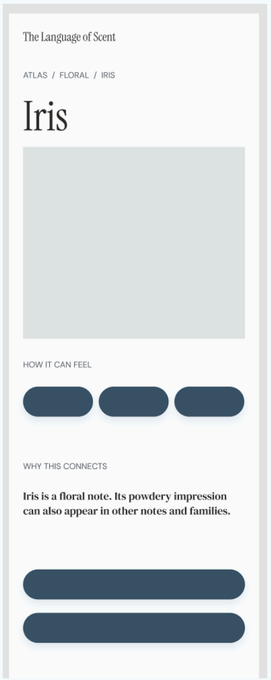
MOBILE

Selected concepts and their details are stacked for focused, touch-based navigation.

MOBILE VIEW 01



MOBILE VIEW 02



CONCEPTUAL MOBILE LAYOUTS – RESPONSIVE BEHAVIOR TO BE REFINED DURING IMPLEMENTATION

Reflection & Next Steps

I originally wanted to help people visualize scents, identify their preferences, and discover similar perfumes. While exploring existing services, I realized that understanding the fragrance descriptions themselves was a challenge worth addressing first.

The most difficult part was organizing overlapping fragrance terms and relationships without making the experience complicated. This led me to simplify the classification, keep shared connections, and reveal details through selection. I am still exploring how sensory comparisons can be made more intuitive.

Next, I plan to build the responsive HTML/CSS experience and refine it through feedback. In the future, I would like to connect this foundation to actual perfumes, personal scent preferences, and similar-fragrance discovery.

Research references: The Perfume Society; The Fragrance Foundation France; Michael Edwards / Fragrances of the World.